



June 2026 Report

There's a generational shift happening in markets, money, and the economy right now:

First, China's economy has been beating the U.S., and its biggest companies are turning record profits into a massive bet on AI, chips, and robots. The spending is huge, but has mostly gone under the radar - so prices haven't caught up yet.

At the same time, countries are quietly backing away from the U.S. dollar. Central banks are stockpiling gold, and the dollar's grip on the world's savings loosens a little more each year. That slow decline is a problem for anyone who collects income in dollars.



And here at home, the U.S. has its own storm brewing: A national debt near \$40 trillion, prices that won't cool down, and rising fears of a recession - even as the stock market hits record highs.

These are what we call Broad Market Shifts - macro forces big enough to move whole markets and economies at once. Each one opens a different door:

- Chinese Tech Growth - for investors chasing growth.
- De-Dollarization - for investors who want steady income.
- A U.S. Economic Downturn - for investors who want to protect their wealth.

Today we'll break down one opportunity for each: Alibaba (BABA) for growth, Altria (MO) for income, and Lockheed Martin (LMT) for protection.

These are names our analysts are actually adding to our portfolio and the reasoning for each.

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GROWTH | ALIBABA (BABA)

Most people know Alibaba as the Amazon of China.

The real story is what it does with all that shopping money: it builds AI, cloud computing, and even its own computer chips.

In other words, the shopping profits pay for the future. But U.S. markets still treat Alibaba like a plain online store, not the tech giant it's becoming. That gap is the opportunity.



For growth investors who think China's tech rise is real, Alibaba may be a potential opportunity worth watching.

Exit Trigger: If that heavy AI spending drags on for years with no payoff - or China cracks down on its tech giants again - the case weakens.

INCOME | ALTRIA (MO)

As the dollar slowly loses value, income investors need a paycheck that can keep up. Altria - the company behind Marlboro - is built for exactly that.

- It has raised its dividend for 57 straight years, and it pays about 6%.

Its secret is simple: it raises prices on its tobacco products faster than inflation eats away at the dollar. So the income it pays you can grow in real value even as the dollar slips.



For income investors who want a paycheck that holds its value, MO may be a potential opportunity to keep an eye on.

Exit Trigger: Altria already pays out most of what it earns, so a tobacco crackdown or a stretched payout would put that 57-year streak at risk.

WEALTH PRESERVATION | LOCKHEED MARTIN (LMT)

When the economy looks shaky, defensive investors want a customer that always pays - and few pay as reliably as the U.S. government.

Lockheed Martin builds fighter jets and missile-defense systems on contracts that run for years, sometimes decades.

- Defense spending is booming, and the company has raised its dividend 22 years in a row.

It tends to hold up whether prices run hot or scared investors dump risky stocks for safe, steady ones.



For investors focused on protecting their wealth, LMT may be a potential opportunity worth watching.

Exit Trigger: A surprise cut to defense spending, or a long delay in a key program like the F-35, would weaken the case.

How These Shifts Could Change

None of these is a sure thing. Beyond each company's own warning signs above, all three ride a big Broad Market Shift that could play out slower - or differently - than expected. The dollar could firm back up, China could stumble, or the U.S. economy could stay strong.

So treat each pick as a single piece of a bigger plan, not the whole plan.

The World Economy Is Changing

Three Broad Market Shifts are reshaping the world's money: China's tech rise, the dollar's slow slip, and a weakening U.S. economy.

The good news? You don't have to bet on just one. Alibaba leans into growth, Altria pays you income, and Lockheed plays defense - one name for each way the world might turn next.

For investors who want a simple way to watch all three shifts at once, these are the names to keep an eye on.

- Briefs Finance Team

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